

Extreme Ownership

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If something goes wrong — even if it's not directly your fault — you still own the outcome. Take complete ownership, not only of those things you are responsible for but also of everything that affects your mission. Make no excuses. Instead of complaining about challenges, focus on developing solutions and resolving problems.

NO BAD TEAMS, ONLY BAD LEADERS

The leader drives performance — or doesn't. It's not what you preach, it's what you tolerate



Believe in the Mission

Why?

If you don't truly believe in what you're doing, your team won't either. The leader must explain not just what to do, but why. You should ask questions to understand and believe in the mission.

CHECK THE EGO

Ego can cloud judgment and cause disruptions. "Remember, it's not about you; it's about the mission and determining the best way to accomplish it."



Discipline and Focus

DISCIPLINE EQUALS FREEDOM

A good leader should be confident, but not arrogant. They should be brave without being reckless. A leader must know when to lead and when to follow. You should be humble, not passive, and take full responsibility for your actions while also allowing others to take charge when needed.



KEEP IT SIMPLE

Keeping things simple is key to success. Plans and orders should be shared clearly and directly. When problems happen (and they will) added complexity can make things worse and lead to serious issues.

PRIORITIZE AND EXECUTE

"Take a moment to relax, look around, and make a call." A leader should stay calm and make the best decisions. Tackle the most important problem first. After you solve that, move on to the next one; don't try to do everything at once. Focusing on one goal can help bring the whole company together.

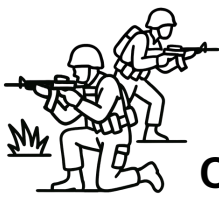


Clarity Before Speed

Don't rush just to look decisive. Make sure everyone understands the goal before you move.

Team and Communication

Brief → Execute → Debrief → Adjust.



COVER AND MOVE

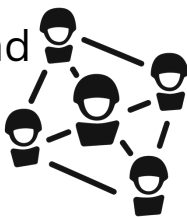
People and teams need to work together, communicate clearly, and support each other. You should eliminate the "us versus them" mindset.

Default to Trust (but Verify)

Assume your people want to succeed. Give them space to act, but check results and offer feedback.

DECENTRALIZED COMMAND

Every leader at every level must be empowered and trusted to lead within the mission, making decisions that support the commander's intent. Decentralized command does not mean junior leaders do their own program; without alignment, that results in chaos.



Calm Is Contagious

Your tone sets the culture.

LEADING UP AND DOWN

Talk clearly to your team and your leaders. Explain what you need and why you need it. Don't assume others know what you mean. Remember, leadership goes both ways; it not only flows down from leaders but also comes up from team members. Take the lead with your peers and your bosses. One key task of any leader is to support their own boss.



Execution and Performance



PLAN

Good planning includes clear objectives, roles, and contingency thinking. Everyone must understand not just what to do, but why. It is essential to develop a standardized planning process. Planning should include: the overall purpose, commander's intent, risks to mitigate, contingencies, and specific courses of action.

Mission Clarity Framework

What is the mission?
Why is it important?
Who is responsible for what?
What does success look like?
What are the key risks and contingencies?

Default: Aggressive, Not Reckless



Take action. Don't wait for perfect information or ideal timing. Move fast but smart.

Always Debrief and Learn

After every project, meeting, or failure — stop and ask: What did we learn?



Two Is One, One Is None

Redundancy matters. Backup owners, second region, spare vendor.



UNCERTAINTY

The picture is never clear. The outcome is never certain. Leaders must be comfortable amid pressure and chaos, and act on logic, not emotion. Leaders must be able to make decisions promptly, then be ready to adjust those decisions quickly.

Growth and Balance

Training Is a Leader's Job



Leaders are directly responsible for making sure their teams are trained, capable, and confident. If the team fails, it's not a "training department" issue it's a leadership failure.

Repetition Builds Discipline

Repetition turns knowledge into instinct. Disciplined, consistent training gives freedom in real situations



Humility and Continuous Learning

Even when you lead, you're still a student. Learn from mistakes, subordinates, and competitors.

Teach Ownership

Help others take responsibility and grow.



Detachment: Step Back to See Clearly

When emotions rise, take a mental step back. Look at the situation from above before reacting.



No Victim Mindset

No excuses. No "because of them" or "the system." You always look for what you can influence.

Slow is smooth, smooth is fast

Slow is smooth means: take your time to do it right. Be deliberate and focused, rather than rushing. When you go too fast, you often make mistakes, forget steps, or lose control.

Smooth is fast means: once you've practised and mastered a task so that it becomes smooth and precise, you'll naturally become faster — without forcing speed.

LEADERSHIP IS SIMPLE, BUT NOT EASY.

A good leader has nothing to prove, yet everything to prove. With Extreme Ownership, any person can develop into a highly effective leader. Lead and win.

"I own that."

"What can I do to help us fix it?"

"Let's simplify this."

"Do you clearly understand why we're doing this?"

"What's our priority right now?"